

## Chapter 41-3

...

The dark environment once again pulled away, retreated, and spun.

Rumble—

Liang Shi suddenly opened her eyes, raised her hand to touch her forehead, and found another handful of cold sweat.

The rain outside was falling even harder, accompanied by lightning and thunder, showing signs of becoming a torrential downpour.

Before she knew it, Liang Shi had actually slept through the entire afternoon.

But this sleep felt like being pressed down by a ghost<sup>1</sup>, leaving her entire body exhausted.

She opened her phone to check and found only a voice message from Ling Dang using Sun Meirou's account, asking if she had gotten home safely.

She replied: [Got home, just took a nap.]

Sun Meirou: [Taking care of Ling Dang must have tired you out. Sorry for the trouble.]

Liang Shi: [Not at all, Ling Dang was very well-behaved. I just like to sleep when I'm free.]

Sun Meirou: [Alright then.]

After exchanging a few more pleasantries with Sun Meirou, the conversation ended.

Liang Shi pressed her head into the pillow, trying to give herself a feeling of suffocation, then released it.

She often used this method to think about things.

After hesitating, she found Qi Jiao's phone number in her contacts, took a deep breath, and dialed.

The phone rang for a long time before the other party answered. Just like last time, it was a very gentle female voice, "Hello."

"Teacher Qi, do you remember me? I'm Liang Shi." Liang Shi introduced herself proactively, "I got your number from Rainbow last time, and we met once at the kindergarten."

Qi Jiao suddenly paused, and there was a very obvious sound of swallowing saliva.

Even through the screen, one could hear her nervousness, "Hello, is there... is there something you need?"

"I want to ask you a rather personal question." Liang Shi asked, "Have you seen me before?"

Qi Jiao: "No... no."

Her stammering revealed a significant problem.

Liang Shi immediately pressed on, "Really? When we were very young, in a dark room, you and I both experienced..."

"Jiao Jiao, eating is eating." A stern female voice came through, "If there's something to discuss, talk about it after the meal. Have you forgotten everything Mama taught you?"

Qi Jiao nervously said, "I remember, I'll hang up right away."

Then she said into the receiver, "Sorry, I need to eat. If there's anything, let's talk about it on Monday."

After saying this, she hung up the phone.

Liang Shi stared at her phone, lost in thought.

Qi Jiao... should remember those childhood events, right?

The main thing was that the feelings in that dream were too real, so real it was as if they had actually kicked her, as if fire had actually burned her.

Those pains felt as though she had truly experienced them.

This wasn't the first time she had received memories about the original body. Previously, regarding the sacrifice incident, including the stories and experiences between Zhou Yi'an and Xu Qingzhu, she had always watched from an outsider's perspective, never having such strong empathy and emotional connection.

Even with that frightening room.

It was limited to just fear.

But Qi Tai Tai terrified her. Just hearing her voice made her scalp tingle.

Liang Shi sent Qi Jiao a text message: [Teacher Qi, see you Monday.]

She still needed to figure this matter out, and Qi Jiao was the best breakthrough point.

Just after sending the text, that familiar mechanical voice entered her mind: [Ding dong! Congratulations to the host for completing the additional task: doing handicrafts with Xu Qingzhu. This little system is deeply gratified this time, but unfortunately, the host failed to complete the task of accumulating 60 luck points in a short time, which would have awarded five luck points, but but but but host you were really close! Just a little bit more and you would have touched the hope of victory, sigh. However, compared to before, this is still great progress.]

[Due to your completion of the additional task, your misfortune points have now returned to zero, luck points accumulated to fifty-four. The reward of 49,999 yuan has been deposited into your account, please check. PS: It hasn't even been a month, and you've already accumulated half the luck points! We're proud of you. If only your progress could be a bit faster.]

Liang Shi: "..."

Her progress wasn't slow!

[Ding dong! Due to the host's good performance, you have gained one opportunity to ask little system a question. Opportunity knocks but once oh!]

Liang Shi didn't hesitate and directly asked, "Did I come here when I was little? Why am I so familiar with Qi Tai Tai?"

System: [...]

After two seconds of silence, that eerie mechanical voice said: [Sorry host, heavenly secrets cannot be revealed.]

Liang Shi: "...?"

"Didn't you say I could ask?" Liang Shi was speechless.

System: [I also didn't say I would definitely answer.]

Liang Shi: "Then what can you answer?"

System: [...For example, the plot line might be slightly collapsing now.]

Liang Shi was surprised: "What?"

Didn't you say it wouldn't collapse?

System: [Forget it, I'll come clean.]

Liang Shi: "?"

System: [I just wanted to kindly remind you that the Liang family's real daughter<sup>2</sup> is about to start looking for her family.]

Liang Shi: "..."

I'm tired, let it all be destroyed.

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**Footnotes:** <sup>1</sup> Ghost pressing down - A Chinese expression for sleep paralysis, the feeling of being unable to move while sleeping <sup>2</sup> Real daughter - In Chinese web novels, refers to the biological daughter who was switched at birth, as opposed to the adopted/fake daughter